

AELITA

PRODUCTION

PRESS RELEASE

Stary Oskol, August 19, 2026

AELITA PRODUCTION Opens the “Tochka Cuire” Festival with the Premiere of “IOV: Material” — the Directorial Debut of Ekaterina Abdulova

On October 23 at 20:00, CSI “Byl” (Stary Oskol, Zhukova microdistrict 38, Blue Hall) hosts “IOV: Material” — the opening production of the first edition of the “Tochka Cuire” contemporary art festival. The production is directed by Ekaterina Abdulova, Co-Founder & Producer of AELITA PRODUCTION — her directorial debut. Genre: a contemporary mystery play, running 1 hour 35 minutes with no interval, 12+, available with the Pushkin Card.

ABOUT THE PRODUCTION

“IOV: Material” is a mystery play inspired by the biblical Book of Job, the philosophy of Kierkegaard and Mamardashvili, and the prose of Kafka, Dostoevsky, Orwell and Chekhov. It is a story of second birth: of how a person, having lost everything, stops being themselves. Of how, at the edge of fear, strength finds a person; in the depths of loneliness a connection to the whole opens up; and guilt meets forgiveness.

Fear need not be conquered — it can be welcomed into the house as a guest. Then all protocols close, and a silence descends in which we hear ourselves and each other.

ABOUT THE DIRECTOR

Ekaterina Abdulova is Co-Founder & Producer of AELITA PRODUCTION (the company was founded in 2025 together with Konstantin Moshnikov). She graduated from the Higher School of Psychology (2010–2015, specialising in Psychology); in 2025 she completed further training at RGISI in Directing. Since 2023 she has produced productions for the dance company “Koroche”.

“IOV: Material” is Ekaterina Abdulova’s debut as a director, previously performed at the Innovation Cultural Centre in Kaluga and on tour in Saint Petersburg, at the New Stage of the Alexandrinsky Theatre. Besides directing and producing, Ekaterina has directed teasers for the productions “Stories. Of the Earthly and the Heavenly”, “Gogol Suite” and “IOV: Material”, and in February 2026 became curator of the photo exhibition “Archaeology of the Human”.

ABOUT THE “TOCHKA CUIRE” FESTIVAL

“Tochka Cuire” is AELITA PRODUCTION’s annual contemporary art festival at CSI “Byl”, Stary Oskol. Its first edition runs October 22–25, 2026: fifteen productions over four days — from the flagship mystery play to physical theatre, performances and a promenade show — plus exhibitions, a business programme and a lecture series. “IOV: Material” opens the festival programme for audiences on October 23.

ABOUT THE VENUE

CSI “Byl” is the first contemporary art centre in the Belgorod region, opened in 2023 in the restored building of the former “Byl” cinema (1982). Two auditoriums — Blue Hall (496 seats) and Red Hall (168 seats) — allow parallel performances.

ABOUT THE COMPANY

AELITA PRODUCTION is a theatre production company founded in 2025 by Ekaterina Abdulova and Konstantin Moshnikov. Over the company's history — more than 10 projects delivered and a presence in 4 Russian cities. The company produces the creation, touring and distribution of productions at the intersection of contemporary theatre, choreography and visual art.

CREATIVE TEAM

Director — Ekaterina Abdulova

Video artist — Ekaterina Ilyina

Composer — Kseniya Shamarina

Choreographer — Yulia Bychkova

Lighting designer — Stanislav Novikov

Assistant director — Konstantin Moshnikov

CAST

IOV — Sergey Vasin (Kaluga Youth Theatre)

ALYOSHA — Viktor Ignatov (Kaluga Youth Theatre)

Performers — dance company “Koroche”: Ekaterina Vitvinina, Grigory Golovkin

DATE, TIME AND PLACE

October 23, 2026, 20:00

CSI “Byl”, Stary Oskol, Zhukova microdistrict 38, Blue Hall

Running time — 1 hr 35 min, no interval · 12+ · available with the Pushkin Card

Tickets: <https://cuire-fest.ru/tickets/show/faac4a31-0e35-47d1-82a1-2f0ca7441fdf>

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